



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

March 11, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Mayor Mahoney.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

A. Citizen Comment – Sale of City Owned Property

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to conduct a public hearing to receive citizen comment on the sale of City-owned property. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Comments were heard.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the February 25, 2025 Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council
Approve the minutes of the regular meeting of the Jackson City Council on February 25, 2025.

B. Special Event Application: DDA Paranormal Tour
Approve a request from Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the DDA Paranormal Tour on March 29, 2025, in downtown Jackson at The Theodore Event Center.

C. Special Event Application: 11th Annual Heart of a Lion 5k
Approve a request from the Jackson Area 19 Special Olympics to host the 11th Annual Heart of a Lion 5k on August 24, 2025, at Ella Sharp Park.

D. Special Event Application: Breakthrough T1D Walk
Approve a request from the Breakthrough T1D Group to host the Breakthrough T1D Walk on June 13-14, 2025, at Ella Sharp Park.

E. Special Event Application: Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect Gathering
Approve a request from the Council of the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect (CPCAN) to host the Prevention of Child Abuse & Neglect Gathering on April 17, 2025, at Austin Blair/Greenwood Park in the City of Jackson.

F. Special Event Application: 10th Annual Recovery Walk

Approve a request from the Home of New Vision to host the 10th Annual Recovery Walk on September 13, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

G. Resignations from Downtown Development Authority

Accept with regret, the resignations of Amy Sayles and Erin Valkuchak from the Downtown Development Authority.

H. Appointment to the Racial Equity Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Shaquay Selby to fill a vacancy on the Racial Equity Commission for a term of 3 years, expiring on 12/31/27.

I. Appointment to the Public Arts Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Elizabeth Ferszt to the Jackson Public Arts Commission, for a term of three years, beginning immediately and ending on May 28, 2028.

J. Appointment to the Affordable Housing Development Board

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Amador Ybarra to the Affordable Housing Development Board for a five-year term, beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2029.

K. Appointment to the Community Police Oversight Commission

Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Vittoria Jimerson to the Community Police Oversight Commission, for a 3-year term beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2027.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS: none.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Proposed PILOT Ordinance – Jackson Interfaith Homes Nonprofit Corporation/Kings Community Homes II LDHA, LLC

Recommendation: *Approve the first reading of an ordinance granting a "PILOT" payment in lieu of taxes exemption to Jackson Interfaith Nonprofit Housing Corporation / King Community Homes II Limited Dividend Housing Association LLC, and associated development agreement. Authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications to the development agreement as necessary.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the first reading of an ordinance granting a "PILOT" payment in lieu of taxes exemption to Jackson Interfaith Nonprofit Housing Corporation / King Community Homes, associated development agreement, and to authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications to the development agreement as necessary. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Proposed Pay-to-Park System

Recommendation: *Approve the replacement of the assessment funded “Meterless Parking” system with a “Pay-to-Park” system for automobile parking within the downtown Central Commercial District by a) approval of the attached resolution for parking system user fees, b) award a contract to Total Parking Solutions, Inc. for the purchase of pay station terminals and associated management system services, c) approval of a contract amendment with Passport Labs, Inc. for payment processing services and d) authorization for the City Manager to execute the appropriate documents.*

City Engineer, Troy White provided the Council with an overview of the proposed pay-to-park system.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the replacement of the assessment funded “Meterless Parking” system with a “Pay-to-Park” system for automobile parking within the downtown Central Commercial District. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Bridge Consulting Services Contract Renewal

Recommendation: *Approve the renewal of the Bridge Consulting Services contract with Great Lakes Engineering, Inc. of Lansing, Michigan for 2025 and 2026 in the amount of \$62,728.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document(s) in accordance with the Purchasing Agent.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the renewal of the Bridge Consulting Services contract with Great Lakes Engineering, Inc. of Lansing, Michigan for 2025 and 2026 in the amount of \$62,728.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate document(s) in accordance with the Purchasing Agent. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Proposed Electric Scooter Ordinance

Recommendation: *Consider First Reading of a proposed Electric Scooter Ordinance, regulating the licensing and operation of electric scooters in the downtown.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the first reading of a proposed Electric Scooter Ordinance, regulating the licensing and operation of electric scooters in the downtown. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. 2024/25 City of Jackson Budget Amendment

Recommendation: *Approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget for the reallocation of general fund dollars, in the amount of \$60,000, to the Curb Appeal Program, adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any/all related documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve an amendment to the 2024-2025 City of Jackson budget for the reallocation of general fund dollars, in the amount of \$60,000, to the Curb Appeal Program, adopt the accompanying budget resolution, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute any/all related documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Sale of City Owned Property

Recommendation: *Approve the sale of City-owned property located at 1211 Ellery Avenue (parcel # 8-1281.0400) to Sayre Builders for \$300, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement and Quit Claim Deed, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the sale of City-owned property located at 1211 Ellery Avenue to Sayre Builders for \$300, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement and Quit Claim Deed, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.

Councilmember Davis abstained from the vote due to a potential conflict of interest.

Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Abstention: Davis. Motion carried.

G. Demolition Contract Award – 736 Page Avenue

Recommendation: *Award a Demolition Contract to Handy Excavating in the Total Amount of \$65,050 to Demolish 736 Page Avenue*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to award a demolition contract to Handy Excavating in the total amount of \$65,050 to demolish 736 Page Avenue. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER’S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene declined to offer comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:49 p.m.